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THE IMPACT OF NATIONAL HIGHER EDUCATION SPORTS EVENT HOSTING ON PERCEPTIONS OF ECONOMIC IMPACT IN MUALLIM DISTRICT, MALAYSIA

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ABSTRACT

Introduction: As a way to promote active and healthy lifestyle, many sports events were organized in Malaysia. However, despite many sporting events organized, it is hard to found studies conducted looking into the impact of the national higher education sport event hosting to the perceptions of economic impact. It is important to look into this area, as without any data, we will be blind of whether the hosting will give positive or negative impacts, or if rather it is positive, is there any other ways for it to be improved. This study aim to find out the impact of a national sports event hosting namely Sukan Institusi Pengajian Tinggi (SUKIPT) or Higher Education Sports on economic sectors in Muallim District, Malaysia.

Methods: Questionnaires were used to gain the data among Muallim residents. 150 peoples that involved in foods/restaurant, accommodations, food delivery services, transportation and retails were recruited as respondents. They were given questionnaires on their perception of the economic impacts on their businesses. Descriptive statistics were used to gain mean and standard deviation while Analysis of Variances were used to compare the economic impacts between sectors.

Results and discussion: Results showed that this event has increased the product and services demand that then contributed to more sales especially in food/restaurant sectors. We also found the transportation sectors to be the least benefit sectors that should be related to easiness or difficulties for them to get the public transport.

Conclusions: The findings of this study can be referred by the authorities especially government generally, and municipality and universities specifically for the planning of next events to be organized in order to enhance socioeconomic values and promote active and healthy lifestyle in all parts in the country.

Keywords: social, economic growth, sport tourism, youth sport.

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O IMPACTO DA HOSPEDAGEM DE EVENTOS ESPORTIVOS DE ENSINO SUPERIOR NACIONAL NA PERCEPÇÃO DO IMPACTO ECONÔMICO NO DISTRITO DE MUALLIM, NA MALÁSIA

RESUMO

Introdução: Como forma de promover um estilo de vida ativo e saudável, muitos eventos esportivos foram organizados na Malásia. No entanto, apesar de muitos eventos desportivos organizados, é difícil encontrar estudos realizados sobre o impacto do evento desportivo nacional de ensino superior que acolhe as percepções de impacto econômico. É importante olhar para essa área, pois, sem dados, ficaremos cegos se o hospedagem dará impactos positivos ou negativos, ou se, pelo contrário, é positivo, há outras maneiras de melhorá-lo. Este estudo visa descobrir o impacto de um evento desportivo nacional que acolhe nomeadamente Sukan Institusi Pengajian Tinggi (SUKIPT) ou Esportes de Educação Superior em setores econômicos no Distrito de Muallim, Malásia.

Métodos: Foram utilizados questionários para obter os dados entre os residentes muçulmanos. Foram recrutados 150 pessoas que estavam envolvidas em alimentos/restaurantes, acomodações, serviços de entrega de alimentos, transporte e varejo. Eles receberam questionários sobre a percepção que tinham dos impactos econômicos em seus negócios. Estatísticas descritivas foram usadas para obter média e desvio padrão, enquanto a Análise de Variações foi usada para comparar os impactos econômicos entre os setores.

Resultados e discussão: Os resultados mostraram que este evento aumentou a demanda de produtos e serviços que, em seguida, contribuíram para mais vendas, especialmente nos setores de alimentos/restaurantes. Também descobrimos que os setores de transporte são os setores menos beneficiados e que devem estar relacionados com a facilidade ou dificuldades para eles obterem o transporte público.

Conclusões: Os resultados deste estudo podem ser encaminhados pelas autoridades, especialmente o governo em geral, e município e universidades, especificamente para o planejamento de próximos eventos a serem organizados, a fim de melhorar os valores socioeconômicos e promover o estilo de vida ativo e saudável em todas as partes do país.

Palavras-chave: social, crescimento econômico, turismo esportivo, esporte juvenil.

1 INTRODUCTION

Tourism has been documented as one of the contributing sector to economy (Ibănescu et al., 2018; Ren et al., 2019). One of the event that can contribute to tourism is sporting events hosting (Muiruri Njoroge et al., 2017; Perić, 2018). It is well known in the more advanced countries that the hosting of sport events will positively benefit local economic development (Elahi et al., 2021). Especially for a place that is not urban or sub-urban, sporting events would become a major generator of tourism as it will attract spectators from all over the place (Maharaj, 2015). Additionally, the tourism might

enhanced not only during sporting events if spectators got to know more what the place offer and get positive experience during the visit (Hemmonsbey & Tichaawa, 2018; Talavera et al., 2019).

While both direct socio-economic and more intangible benefits of sporting events certainly exist, the presence of sporting events may bring with it some negative impacts as well (González-García et al., 2018; Tichaawa et al., 2015). In Malaysia, every two years, there will be Higher Education Sport (In Malay language: Sukan Institusi Pengajian Tinggi or more known as 'SUKIPT') hosted by a university or higher education Institute. SUKIPT is regarded as the biggest sporting events for the students of higher education institute in Malaysia. In 2022, SUKIPT were hosted by Universiti Pendidikan Sultan Idris (UPSI). UPSI is located in in Muallim District, Perak. As the size of Muallim could be considered small as compared to other districts in Perak, the impact of any big events could possibly felt by majority places in the district.

With so many athletes, coaches, managers and fans coming to Muallim, the impact should be felt by those involve in several economic sectors such as foods/restaurant, accommodations, food delivery services, transportation and retails. However, still the effects will be depending on how much the teams or individuals need them and how easy or difficult for them to get access to those. Doing a research in this area is important, as it can demonstrate to the city municipality of what Muallim do offer to those that come to the district.

Although many sporting events events has been organized by UPSI, no studies has yet been conducted looking into the impact of the sports hosting to the socioeconomic of the Muallim residents. Question exist whether the hosting of sport event impacted economic sectors in this district. It is important to look into this area, as without any data, we will be blind of whether the hosting will give positive or negative impacts, or if rather it is positive, is there any other ways for it to be improved (Chersulich Tomino et al., 2020; Kenyon & Bodet, 2018). Thus, it is the objective of this study to determine the impact of SUKIPT hosting on perception of economic impact in Muallim district.

2 THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

Using a descriptive quantitative approach, this article aims to determine how the hosting of national sport event impacted the economic perception in Muallim District, Malaysia.

3 METHODOLOGY

3.1 PARTICIPANTS

150 peoples that involved in foods/restaurant, accommodations, food delivery services, transportation and retails were recruited as respondents. All the respondents are living in Muallim district in the range of 15 km from the main venue. The sectors involved includes; i) food (eg. restaurants, hawkers, etc), ii) accomodations (eg. Hotels, homestays, etc), iii) food delivery services (shopee food, food panda, grabfood etc), iv) transportation (eg. taxis, grab, etc) and v) groceries (eg. Shops, supermarkets).

3.2 ECONOMIC IMPACT ASSESSMENT

To assess the economic impact of the SUKIPT hosting on Muallim economy, questionnaires were given to answer five main questions on the analysis of economic impact:

i. Does SUKIPT increase the service demand, product demand and sales?
ii. Does SUKIPT increase their customer?
iii. Does SUKIPT cause them to take new workers due to many customers?
iv. Does the sales made during SUKIPT is higher compared to other events?
v. Does SUKIPT give more chances for them to promote their business to new market/customers?
vi. Does SUKIPT makes they think that they can open a new branch?

3.3 DATA COLLECTION TECHNIQUES

Data collection was conducted by face to face interviews using questionnaires by trained data collectors conversant with local languages.

3.4 DATA ANALYSIS

Participants demographic such as gender, marriage status and business types were collected and presented in terms of percentage. All the data was analysed for its mean and standard deviation and also compared between economic sectors using Analysis of Variances (ANOVA). Statistical Package for Social Science (SPSS) version 20 was used to analysed the data.

4 RESULTS

Table 1 showed the demographic information of the respondents that consisted of 150 peoples involved in the economic sectors of interest in Muallim.

Table 1. Participants Background

Demographic	Number	Percent (%)
Gender		
Male	102	68.00
Female	48	32.00
Marriage Status		
Single	33	22.00
Married and others	117	78.00
Business Type		
Accomodation	20	13.33
Food/restaurant	71	47.33
Food delivery	26	17.33
Transportation	11	7.34
Retail	22	14.67

Source: By the authors

Five level Likert Scale was used to measure the impact of SUKIPT to the business in Muallim; i) Highly Disagree, ii) Disagree, iii) Neutral/Not Sure, iv) Agree and v) Highly Agree). Table 2 showed the results of how the business impacts during SUKIPT. SUKIPT was shown to had given positive impact to the business in Muallim.

Table 2. Impact of SUKIPT on business in Muallim

Item	HDA	DA	N/NS	A	HA
SUKIPT increase the service demand, product demand and sales.	0.67%	0.0%	0.0%	13.33%	86.0%
SUKIPT increase my customers.	0.7%	4.6%	4.0%	14.0%	76.7%
SUKIPT cause me to take new workers due to many customers.	76.0%	0.7%	0.0%	10.7%	12.6%
The sales I made during SUKIPT is higher compared to other events.	2.0%	0.0%	4.7%	12.0%	81.3%
SUKIPT give more chances for me to promote my business to new market/customers.	3.3%	3.4%	5.3%	13.3%	74.7%
SUKIPT makes me think that I can open a new branch.	29.0%	4.0%	18.0%	17.0%	32.0%

*Note : HDA-Highly Disagree, DA-Disagree, N/NS-Neutral/Not Sure, A-Agree, HA-Highly Agree

Source: By the authors

Table 3 showed the the impact of SUKIPT on business according to sectors.

Table 3. Impact of SUKIPT on business according to sectors

Items	Sectors	Mean	SD	Sig.
SUKIPT increase the service demand, product demand and sales.	Accommodation	4.87	0.34	.005
	Food/restaurant	5.00	0.00	
	Food delivery	4.81	0.40	
	Transportation	4.36	1.21	
	Retail	4.86	0.35	
SUKIPT increase my customers.	Accommodation	4.86	0.35	.000
	Food/restaurant	5.00	0.00	
	Food delivery	4.36	1.21	
	Transportation	3.65	1.20	
	Retail	4.73	0.70	
SUKIPT cause me to take new workers due to many customers.	Accommodation	1.50	1.24	.002
	Food/restaurant	2.25	1.76	
	Food delivery	1.12	0.59	
	Transportation	1.00	0.00	
	Retail	2.05	1.59	
The sales I made during SUKIPT is higher compared to other events.	Accommodation	4.70	0.98	.001
	Food/restaurant	4.89	0.40	
	Food delivery	4.62	0.85	
	Transportation	3.91	1.38	
	Retail	4.64	0.49	
SUKIPT give more chances for me to promote my business to new market/customers.	Accommodation	4.95	0.22	.000
	Food/restaurant	5.00	0.00	
	Food delivery	3.69	1.74	
	Transportation	4.41	0.91	
	Retail	4.68	0.58	
SUKIPT makes me think that I can open a new branch.	Accommodation	3.20	1.77	.000
	Food/restaurant	4.18	1.11	
	Food delivery	2.31	1.52	
	Transportation	2.18	0.87	
	Retail	2.82	1.65	

Source: By the authors

Based on Table 3, One Way ANOVA analysis showed there is significant main effects in each items. For the first item, pairwise comparison analysis showed Food/restaurants sector does has bigger impacts in terms of increased product and service demand, and sales demand compared to food delivery (p = .029), transportation (p = .02) and retails (p = .006). For the second item, it was shown that transportation sector is the least to benefit in terms of customer increment when compared to other sectors (all p =

.000). For the third item, results not showing positive outcome, as majority of business did not have to take new employees to cover the business during SUKIPT.

Nest, for the forth item, in terms of greater sales recorded when compared to other events that the university or district has ever organized, it has been found that the food/restaurant and accommodation sectors did reported greater in comparison to transportation sector (p = 0.00). For the fifth item, in terms of chances to promote the business to new market or customers, the accommodation and food/restaurant sectors were more agreed compared to food delivery services and transportation sectors (p = 0.000). For the sixth item, the food/restaurant sector has greater scored compared to other sectors; accommodation (p = .049), food delivery service (p = .000), transportation (p = .000) and retails (p=.001).

5 DISCUSSION

Realizing the importance of analyzing the impact of hosting a big sports event to the host city (Lin & Lu, 2018; Rojas-Méndez et al., 2019), this study was conducted. 150 respondents that involved in foods/restaurant, accommodations, food delivery services, transportation and retails were given questionnaires on their perception of the economic impacts on their businesses. Comparison were made between sectors of interests namely; i) food (eg. restaurants, hawkers, etc), ii) accomodations (eg. Hotels, homestays, etc), iii) food delivery services (shopee food, food panda, grabfood etc), iv) transportation (eg. taxis, grab, etc) and v) groceries (eg. Shops, supermarkets).

Results showed each sectors achieved good responses from the respondents in terms of service demand, product demand and sales in all sectors that were improved during SUKIPT. The findings were in line with many previous studies including (Swart et al., 2018). Food and restaurant sectors have been shown to have the most impact as all the responders strongly agreed the positive impact of the SUKIPT. Besides that, food and restaurant sector has been shown to be more impacted compared to food delivery, transportation and retails. This could be due to not all the respondents got the improvement of sales during the event (Talavera et al., 2019).

Besides that, all sectors were found to provide good responses except for the transportation sectors in terms of customer increment. Transportation sector was shown to be the least to benefit and significantly lower in terms of customer increment when compared to other sectors. Among the factors can be explained by every participated

teams has their own transportation and the athletes might more preferred to move as a group by their team transportation. Besides that, this might well be explained by the already equipped food and other basic requirements in their hostel. Another possible reason might be due to no modern shopping mall or any other attraction for the young to go outside. However, this should be look as positive, as the athletes can be fully focus on what they supposed to be; that is, to win the game.

Results also not showing positive outcome in terms of job creation. Majority of business did not have to take new employees to cover the business during SUKIPT. This is somewhat expected, as this is their chances to increased their profit, so the additional worker might reduced the profit. Besides, the increment of customer might not be too obvious that cause them to take new workers. However, the previous study showed otherwise (Elahi et al., 2021) in which job creation was increase that benefitted peoples in the host city. Many factors could be considered on the differences result, and one of them includes the level of event, in which bigger event especially international level should be more capable of attracting more peoples to the city.

In terms of greater sales recorded when compared to other events that the university or district has ever organized, results showed all sectors provide good responses except for the transportation sectors. As one of the biggest event in sports in Malaysia, the hosting of SUKIPT has really give positive impact to the district. With all the higher education institution sent their best athlete to come and live for several days in Muallim, this seems to be really good for the district. It has been found that the food/restaurant and accommodation sectors did reported greater in comparison to transportation sector. Among the contributing factor to the positive outcome is the involvement of the community of Muallim District to the event. The community joined to watch the games and hence is likely to also went to the restaurants after watching the games (Yapanto et al., 2023).

Additionally, in terms of chances to promote the business to new market or customers, results showed all sectors provide good responses except for the transportation sectors. This could be contributed to the various athletes that might need many kind of things from the businessmen. The accommodation and food/restaurant sectors were more agreed compared to food delivery services and transportation sectors.

Lastly, only food/restaurant sectors provide good responses when asked about creating new branch. This is again expected as food/restaurants are among the only thing

that needed everyday. Unlike other sectors, food should be kept fresh thus buying it provide better option to eat more healthy and delicious. The food/restaurant sector has greater scored compared to other sectors; accommodation (p = .049), food delivery service (p = .000), transportation (p = .000) and retails (p=.001).

With the results found in this study, it is hope that Muallim district, as a place that is still rich with nature will be preserved and planned well to attract more tourist that will then increase economic impacts to the residents (Helmi & Naparin, 2023).

6 CONCLUSION

The findings of this study can be referred by the authorities especially government generally, and Muallim district municipality and UPSI specifically for the planning of next events to be organized. A better plan of sport hosting is expected to be conducted in this district following the presentation of the data. The finding will also demonstrate the needed areas to be improve such as types of events, selection of venues, underutilization of public sporting infrastructures and timing of the events.

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